



FRAMING THE HARBOR

Known locally as the “coat hanger,” the bridge is illuminated at night and forms an iconic part of Sydney’s panorama. The bridge regularly features in spectacular light shows in Sydney and is the centerpiece of Sydney’s New Year’s fireworks displays.

Sydney Harbour Bridge

A giant steel arch forming the centerpiece of one of the world’s most dramatic harbors

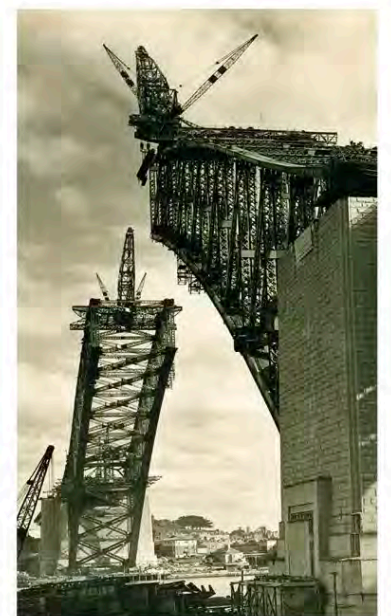
The idea to build a bridge across Sydney Harbour connecting Sydney to the North Shore was first discussed in 1815, but it was not until the early 20th century that the proposal was taken seriously. In 1914, John Bradfield was appointed Chief Engineer of Sydney Harbour Bridge and Metropolitan Railway Construction. His work on the project later earned him the nickname “father of the bridge,” such was his determination to see it built. Under his direction, the government approved the project in 1922 and design tenders were invited worldwide. In 1924, the British engineering firm Dorman Long & Co. Ltd. from Middlesbrough won the contract.

The winning contract

Well known as the builders of the Tyne Bridge in Newcastle, the winning firm proposed a similar arch bridge in Sydney. An arch was cheaper than the alternative cantilever and suspension bridges proposed, and also provided great rigidity to carry the expected heavy loads. Construction began on July 23, 1923, and was finished on January 19, 1932. The completed bridge was 3,770 ft (1,149 m) long and 440 ft (134 m) high. Its total width of 160 ft (49 m) allowed for six lanes of traffic, two lanes of trams, a path for pedestrians, a dedicated path for cyclists, and two railway tracks.



SE. Australia



△ BRIDGING THE GAP

This photograph from August 1930 shows the two arms of the arch gradually coming together in the center.